PLATFORM DOCUMENTATION

Bethel Connect

Comprehensive product documentation for the Bethel Connect User App and Bethel Admin Connect, including workflows, responsibilities, feature behavior, and operational guidance.

Prepared For

Bethel Connect platform stakeholders, testers, and church leaders

Generated

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Scope

User App, Admin App, shared workflows, and operational model

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Platform Overview

Bethel Connect is a connected church operations platform made up of two distinct products that serve different audiences while working from the same core data model. The User App supports church members, guests, and approved volunteers. The Admin App supports church administrators, super administrators, and other leadership roles responsible for approvals, communication, Sunday planning, event coordination, and church setup.

The platform is designed around a church-scoped operating model. Members belong to a specific church, access requests are routed to the corresponding church administration flow, and most content is intentionally filtered by the member's church. At the same time, some meetings and events are shared across the wider Bethel network, so the platform also supports common announcements and common events that appear across all churches where appropriate.

User App

Guest exploration, access request flow, approved member dashboard, Sunday planning, prayer, calendar, announcements, and meetings.

Admin App

Approval queue, prayer moderation, member management, ministry planning, announcements, events, church setup, and operational oversight.

> The platform uses a deliberate separation of concerns: public discovery and member experience are kept simple in the User App, while operational control and sensitive actions are kept inside the Admin App.

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Shared Concepts and Operating Model

Church-scoped access | Google sign-in | Approval-based membership | Common and church-specific events | Sunday service planning | Prayer moderation

Church identity

Every church location is represented using the Bethel naming convention, such as Bethel Nuremberg or Bethel Cologne. This convention appears throughout the app so that members and admins always understand which church context they are operating in.

Access and approval

The platform currently uses Google sign-in as the primary authentication method. Signing in does not automatically grant member access. A user must first request access by selecting the church they belong to. That request is then reviewed by the relevant church administrator. Once approved, the same Google account can sign in and move directly into the member experience.

Content distribution model

- Church-specific content appears only for members of that church.
- Common Bethel meetings can be visible across all churches and even in guest mode.
- Announcements and events can be published either locally or network-wide.
- Prayer requests are moderated and visible only inside the relevant church context after approval.

3

Chapter One: Bethel Connect User App

The User App is the member-facing side of the platform. It is intentionally designed to support two very different states: the public discovery experience for guests, and the private ministry experience for approved members. The app also supports intermediate access states so that a person can sign in, submit a church access request, wait for approval, and then transition smoothly into their private member dashboard.

3.1 User App structure

The top-level structure of the User App is organized around four main areas.

Access / Member | Explore | Meetings | Help

In guest mode, the first top-level tab is Access. After approval, that first top-level tab becomes Member. This gives the app a consistent layout while still adapting to the user's current state.

3.2 Guest experience

Guests can browse public church information without entering the private member area. This keeps the app useful for first-time visitors while still protecting member-only content.

Explore

Explore is the public discovery area. It uses sub-tabs so guests can move directly to the type of information they want without scrolling through a very long page.

- **About Us:** explains the church background, multicultural identity, worship culture, and expansion across Europe.
- **Church Locations:** presents Bethel church locations with service times and local context.
- **Connect with us:** groups YouTube and Instagram connectivity in one place.
- **Facebook:** provides the Facebook connection path.
- **Contact Us:** combines the church website and contact route in one panel.

Meetings

Guests can also see Bethel Church Common Meetings. These are the regular network-wide meeting rhythms that help visitors understand how the church lives and gathers through the week.

- Daily Intercessory Prayer, except Sundays
- Mid Week Meeting
- Youth Meeting

Access

Access is the guest entry point into the secure member flow. It contains the sign-in action and clearly explains that access is granted only to church members after approval by the church admin.

3.3 Sign-in and member approval workflow

1. The user taps Continue With Google.
2. If the user does not already have approved access, the app opens the request-access flow.
3. The user selects the church they belong to and can add an optional message.
4. The request is routed to the corresponding church admin for approval.
5. Until approval is granted, the user stays in an awaiting-approval state.
6. Once approved, the same Google sign-in takes the user directly into the member area.

> The app is deliberately designed so that authentication and authorization are separate. Signing in proves account identity. Approval grants church membership access.

3.4 Approved member mode

Approved members receive a dedicated member workspace. On mobile, the app uses a fixed header strip and tab structure so members can navigate quickly without losing orientation.

The member area currently groups private content into the following major views:

Home | My Teams & Plans | Announcements | Calendar | Prayer

3.5 Member header strip and navigation model

The fixed header strip in member mode keeps core identity information always visible. It shows the church logo, church name, member name, current role or mode, and the sign-out action. Under that, the main member tabs stay visible so the user can move between sections quickly.

This design reduces confusion on mobile devices because the user no longer needs to scroll back to the top of a long page to change context.

3.6 Home

Home acts as the member dashboard. It is intended to answer the question, “What should I pay attention to right now?” rather than duplicating every detail already available in deeper sections.

- Highlights the next upcoming event.
- Surfaces the next Sunday responsibility when one exists.
- Shows church-specific context for the member’s current church.
- Provides a fast summary before the user moves into planning, calendar, prayer, or announcements.

3.7 My Teams & Plans

This section combines team identity with practical ministry planning so the member can see both where they serve and what they are expected to do next.

My teams

- Shows the current church role assigned to the member.
- Lists the teams the member belongs to, such as Worship Team, Speakers Team, Tech Team, Sunday School Team, or Food Team.
- Helps members understand why they are being assigned certain Sunday responsibilities.

My Sunday plan

- Groups assignments by Sunday and by activity instead of showing a flat list.
- Lets the member accept or decline assignments.
- Automatically removes stale Sunday requests after the Sunday service window has passed.
- Removes assignments from active response view when the assignment is deleted or reassigned by an admin.

Support in your church

This area provides guidance and contact pathways for church-specific support needs. It is where the member can understand how to get help if they have ministry-planning questions or service-related issues.

3.8 Announcements

Announcements combines communication and event awareness in one place. The goal is to simplify the member experience by reducing the number of separate sections they need to check.

Announcements tile

- Shows church-specific or common announcements based on publication scope.
- Uses church identity labels instead of exposing internal publisher emails.
- Automatically hides announcements after their configured visibility duration ends.
- Removes publishing date and time from the member-facing announcement view to keep the interface simpler.

Events tile under Announcements

- Displays church-specific events and common events below the announcement content.
- Can show event posters when one is published by leadership.
- Supports multi-day event behavior in the calendar model.
- Automatically removes events from active display when the event end time has passed.

3.9 Calendar

Calendar is one of the most important member coordination tools. It combines recurring default meetings, church-specific meetings, Sunday Service, and published events into one coherent month view.

- Opens on the current month by default.
- Highlights today's date for quick orientation.
- Uses month-name navigation rather than generic previous and next labels.
- On mobile, keeps day tiles visually lighter by removing excess label text inside date cells.
- Supports auto-scroll to the day's event detail tile when a date is tapped on mobile.

What the calendar includes

- **Sunday Service:** created automatically for every Sunday, based on the current service time of the member's church, with a 2.5-hour service duration in the event model.
- **Bethel Church Common Meetings:** recurring shared meetings that appear across churches.
- **Church Specific Meetings:** recurring meetings for the member's own church.
- **Published events:** local or common events created by leadership.

Meeting tiles and event actions

- Common meetings are visible in their own section and can include a Join button for online meetings.
- Church-specific meetings appear under the approved member area for the specific church.

- Where relevant, events support Add To Calendar and Download Invite actions.

3.10 Prayer

Prayer now combines personal submission and shared prayer participation into a single streamlined space. This reduces fragmentation and makes it easier for members to understand the full prayer workflow of the church.

Submit prayer request

- Members can submit a prayer request from the Prayer section.
- Requests can be shared anonymously if the member prefers.
- The request is visible publicly only after moderation and approval.

My prayer requests

- Shows the user's own submitted requests.
- Lets the member understand whether a request is waiting, approved, or no longer active.
- Allows the member to remove their own prayer requests.

Prayer Wall

- Appears below My prayer requests inside the same Prayer page.
- Displays approved prayer requests from the same church as tiles.
- Supports a Pray action, which changes to Prayed for that user only.
- Does not reveal private response state to other members.

3.11 Meetings experience

Meetings has both a public and private dimension. Public users can see the common rhythm of the church network, while approved members also see the meetings specific to their church.

Bethel Church Common Meetings

- Daily Intercessory Prayer, except Sundays
- Mid Week Meeting
- Youth Meeting

These are marked as online by default in the app and appear both in the dedicated meetings area and in the calendar model.

Church Specific Meetings

Each church can have its own meeting rhythm in addition to Sunday Service. For example, Bethel Nuremberg includes Bible Reading and Church Intercessory Prayer. These appear as church-specific meeting tiles and also feed the calendar.

3.12 Help

The Help section is a built-in operating guide for users. It explains the full journey from guest discovery to approved member use, and it also provides recommended weekly workflows so people know how to use the app effectively rather than only knowing where features are located.

3.13 User app design principles

- Keep guest exploration open and simple.
- Keep member access protected through approval.
- Reduce long-page fatigue with tab structures and automatic scrolling to the relevant content tile.
- Keep private church content scoped to the relevant church.
- Use a mobile-first navigation pattern for approved members.

4

Chapter Two: Bethel Admin Connect

Bethel Admin Connect is the operational control center for the platform. It is a web-based admin dashboard focused on controlled access, structured oversight, and practical church operations. Its primary responsibility is not public presentation but administration: making sure the right people are approved, the right members are assigned, Sunday plans are accurate, events are communicated, and church data remains current.

4.1 Admin app navigation structure

Overview | Approval Queue | Members | Team Planning | Announcements and Events | Churches And Teams | Role Matrix | Help

The selected church context shapes much of the dashboard behavior. Most actions apply to the chosen church unless an admin is intentionally creating a network-wide event or acting as a super admin across churches.

4.2 Overview

Overview is the operational front page. It is intended to answer what needs attention now rather than replace the specialized tools deeper in the dashboard.

- Summarizes church readiness and current operational signals.
- Highlights the next upcoming event using the same logic used in the member-facing app.
- Surfaces approvals waiting, member follow-up, planning context, and recent activity.
- Acts as the recommended daily starting point for admins.

4.3 Approval Queue

Approval Queue combines two important moderation tasks in one place: new member access requests and prayer moderation. This keeps sensitive approval work together and helps admins maintain a clear daily review routine.

Access approvals

- Requests are routed by the church selected in the User App.
- Queue supports search, filtering, visibility counts, and bulk operations.

- Approving a request grants baseline member access, not elevated permissions.

Prayer moderation

- Prayer requests appear below access approvals in their own moderation tile.
- Super admins and church admins can approve, hide, or remove prayer requests.
- Approved requests appear on the Prayer Wall for members in that church.

4.4 Members

Members is the control area for approved people after onboarding. It is where church leadership can maintain role, team membership, and data quality.

- Supports search and sorting for easier member discovery.
- Filters by church, role, team, and status.
- Allows editing of member email, role, and team membership.
- Supports deletion of members by church admins and super admins, within the allowed permission model.
- When a member is deleted, they lose access to the private member area until they are approved again.

> Member approval and elevated permissions are intentionally separate. Approval creates a member. Administrative elevation should happen only inside Members, with intent and review.

4.5 Team Planning

Team Planning is the structured ministry scheduling tool for Sunday service operations. It is designed around one person per role for each activity, helping church leaders avoid duplication and ambiguity in service planning.

Core planning workflow

1. Select the Sunday and church context.
2. Assign people to the required ministry roles.
3. Confirm the activity plan.
4. Publish assignments to the relevant members.

Important planning behaviors

- Confirmation is idempotent for the same person, role, church, and Sunday combination.

- Members can accept or decline assignments from their app.
- If an assignment is removed, the member no longer sees it as active.
- Archived Sundays can be reviewed later for service history and comparison.

4.6 Announcements and Events

This section manages outgoing communication and scheduled event visibility. It supports both church-specific communication and common network communication.

Announcements

- Publish announcements to the selected church or broader scope where supported.
- Choose a display duration such as 7, 14, or 30 days, or set a custom end date.
- Delete announcements after publishing when needed.
- Announcements automatically stop appearing in the User App after their visibility window ends.

Published events

- Publish events as church-specific or common Bethel events.
- Attach posters to improve visibility for members.
- Manage events in separate lower sections for church-specific events and common events.
- Delete published events from those management tiles.

Default recurring meetings

- Common meetings such as Daily Intercessory Prayer, Mid Week Meeting, and Youth Meeting are represented in the admin model.
- Church-specific default meetings, including Sunday Service and church recurring meetings, are also represented.
- Admins can delete specific occurrences where a meeting does not take place.

4.7 Churches And Teams

Churches And Teams is the structural configuration area. It manages the physical and operational identity of each church.

- Create and edit church locations.
- Maintain church details, support contacts, social links, and service times.
- Maintain the team structure used elsewhere in planning and member assignment.

- Keep church naming, service information, and public-facing details consistent.

Because Sunday Service and other recurring meeting behavior depend on church service time and church metadata, this section has downstream impact on the calendar and meeting experience in the User App.

4.8 Role Matrix

Role Matrix functions as a reference view for the permission model. It helps leadership understand the intent of each role even though enforcement is ultimately controlled by application logic and Firestore rules rather than this view itself.

- Super Admin: broad cross-church authority.
- Church Admin: strong local church operational authority.
- Pastor: church leadership role with practical visibility but more limited destructive authority in some flows.
- Volunteer and Member: narrower service and participation roles.

Whether the Role Matrix remains visible is a product-design choice. It is useful as a reference, but it is not the source of permission truth.

4.9 Help

The Admin Help section is a built-in operating guide that explains what each dashboard area is for, how to move through the app in a safe daily order, and how to avoid common mistakes such as mixing approval work with role elevation or losing track of Sunday planning responsibilities.

4.10 Recommended admin operating workflow

1. Start in Overview.
2. Open Approval Queue for new members and prayer moderation.
3. Use Members to verify the right role, email, and team configuration.
4. Use Team Planning to shape and confirm Sunday service activity plans.
5. Use Announcements and Events to publish current communication and upcoming meetings.
6. Use Churches And Teams when church identity, service time, or contact structure changes.

5

Security, Governance, and Operational Notes

5.1 Access governance

- Google sign-in identifies the account, but approval governs member access.
- Church selection during request flow determines the approval route.
- Member deletion removes effective access to the private member area.

5.2 Prayer governance

- Prayer requests are moderated before appearing publicly on the Prayer Wall.
- Anonymous sharing is supported for the requesting member.
- Pray and Prayed state is private to the member who clicked it.

5.3 Event governance

- Events can be common or church-specific.
- Recurring common and church-specific meetings feed both dedicated tiles and the calendar model.
- Deleted or cancelled occurrences disappear from member-facing views.
- Expired events and announcements are automatically removed from active display.

5.4 Mobile behavior

- The User App has been optimized for mobile use with fixed navigation, section grouping, and reduced long-page scrolling.
- Auto-scroll behavior is used to bring the user directly to relevant tiles after tab selection.
- Calendar tiles are visually simplified on phone screens.

5.5 Closing summary

Bethel Connect is more than a simple information app. It is an operating environment for church communication, church administration, ministry planning, and member participation. The User App emphasizes clarity, access control, and practical weekly use. The Admin App emphasizes

operational control, moderation, planning accuracy, and church structure. Together they form a connected but role-sensitive platform that supports both church life and church operations.